

"Every one of us has had that moment — you look up, and somehow it's been 40 minutes, and you can't name a single thing you just saw."

A brilliant interface designer : **Aza Raskin 2006**

Jef Raskin, started the Macintosh project

Netflix — a company whose entire business is keeping you on the couch — built in a stopping cue: 'Are you still watching?'

old media was finite by *physics* . The newspaper ran out. The show ended. The book had a back cover.

Angle 1: Should it be banned on kids' apps?

- *Yes, and it's already happening:* New York, California, Minnesota
- *No — the smart counter: **time limits, mandatory stopping cues, no engagement-ranked feeds for minors***
- *Your proof platforms can do it:* "Instagram added 'You're all caught up.' TikTok set 60-minute defaults for teens.

Angle 2: Is the scroll the villain, or just a symptom?

- every design gets A/B tested against one question: *does it keep them here longer?*

ANALOGY BANK

- **The casino:** "A casino removes clocks, windows, and cash. A feed removes pages, endings, and clocks. Same playbook, different chips."

SOMETHING TO DO TONIGHT

Re-add the friction the designers removed:

- Log out every time.
- Take the app off your home screen so you have to search.
- Kill autoplay first — biggest single win.
- Turn on grayscale; the feed is a lot less delicious in black and white.

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THE ORIGIN STORY (Q1–5)

What exactly is infinite scroll, in plain English?

Your feed used to *end* . You'd reach the bottom of a page and make a choice: click 'next,' or go do something with your life. Infinite scroll deletes the bottom of the page. Content loads as you swipe

Was it designed to be addictive from day one? "No — and that's the cautionary part. It was built to remove friction,

THE REGRET (Q6–9)

Why does the inventor regret it?

wastes the equivalent of hundreds of thousands of human lifetimes of attention, every month.

Does the inventor want it banned?

He wants the *business model* redesigned — stopping cues, humane defaults, systems that stop competing for every minute.

THE PSYCHOLOGY (Q10–16)

Why can't we just stop scrolling? psychology — *variable rewards* . proved it pigeons: unpredictable payoffs grip harder than predictable ones.

What's a "stopping cue," and why did we lose them?

anything that says 'natural pause here.' The end of the newspaper. The back cover of the book.

What's the Zeigarnik effect? "Unfinished tasks occupy the mind more than finished ones — that's the Zeigarnik effect. A feed with no ending is a task that never completes.

Why is autoplay such a big deal? "Because autoplay removes even the *decision* to continue. converts an active choice into a default



THE BUSINESS MODEL (Q21–25)



THE FIXES (Q41–47)

What's the #1 thing viewers can do tonight? "Kill autoplay first — it's the biggest single win, because it re-inserts a decision the design deleted. Second: turn off the red badges;

Does grayscale mode really help? "Try it — your screen becomes remarkably less delicious.

What are the best 'friction' tricks? "Re-add what the designers removed. Log out after every session — typing your password is a surprisingly great therapist. Delete the app and use the browser.

Why does 'phone in another room' work so well? "Best research finding I know: studies show your phone drains cognitive capacity even when it's off and face-down — merely *knowing* it's there costs you.

What's the bedtime rule? "Physical, not moral:



THE FUTURE (Q48–50)

Will AI make this worse? "Yes, and it's simple math. Infinite scroll was a bottomless bowl with finite cooks. Now content generation is effectively unlimited and personalized in real time.

Can design be ethical? Can this be fixed? "Absolutely. Humane technology is a real movement, and the same minds that removed the stopping cues can put them back